

Mini Incident Response Plan

Company

ABC Online Store (Hypothetical)

Incident Scenario

An unsecured API endpoint exposed customer data including names, email addresses, phone numbers, and hashed passwords.

1. Preparation

- Create an Incident Response Team.
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
- Perform regular backups.
- Monitor logs using SIEM.
- Conduct employee security awareness training.

2. Detection & Analysis

The SIEM system detected unusual API requests. The security team reviewed server logs and confirmed unauthorized access to customer records.

3. Containment

- Disable the vulnerable API endpoint.
- Revoke compromised API keys.
- Block malicious IP addresses.
- Isolate affected systems.

4. Eradication

- Patch the API vulnerability.
- Remove unauthorized access.
- Reset passwords and API keys.
- Scan systems for malware.

5. Recovery

- Restore services safely.
- Verify system integrity.
- Monitor for suspicious activity.
- Confirm normal operations.

6. Lessons Learned

- Improve API security.
- Perform regular penetration testing.
- Strengthen monitoring and logging.
- Update the Incident Response Plan.

Communication Plan

Immediately notify:

- Incident Response Team
- IT Manager
- Senior Management
- Legal/Compliance Team
- Affected customers (if required)

Preventive Measures

1. Secure APIs with authentication and authorization.
2. Conduct regular vulnerability assessments.
3. Enable continuous security monitoring.

Conclusion

The incident was successfully contained, the vulnerability was fixed, and additional security controls were implemented to reduce future risks.